

Religion

Etymology

- 1) Derived from a **French word** “*reliun*” which means “Respect for what is sacred”
- 2) Derived from a **Latin root word** “*Religionem*” which means “Reverence for the gods”

Definitions

- 1) Belief in spiritual beings (**Edward Burnett Taylor**)
- 2) Unified system of Beliefs and practices relative to sacred things (**David Emile Durkheim**)
- 3) The feelings, acts and experiences of individual men in their solitude, whatever they may consider the divine (**William James**)
- 4) A complete system of life based on the directions given by the Creator to mankind time to time for His slaves (mankind & Jinn) to the success in here and in hereafter” (**Islamic verdict of Din**)

Need of Religion

- To caters human spiritual needs
- To caters human materialistic needs
- Call / demand of human nature
- Satisfaction of mind by answering its emerging questions
- Optimism

Fundamentals of Religion

- 1) Faith & Beliefs
- 2) Traditions & Rituals/practices
- 3) Ethics

Classification of Religion

- 1) **Divine/Revealed/Abrahamic/Semitic Religions.** Judaism, Christianity and Islam
- 2) **Non-divine/Unrevealed/Non-Abrahamic/Non-Semitic Religions.** Buddhism and Hinduism

History of Religion/ How did enter the religion in human life?

- 1) Evolutionary theory
- 2) Divine theory

Evolutionary theory

Based on Darwin’s THEORY OF EVOLUTION

Has Six Stages

- 1) **Pre-Animism** (Age of Ignorance/No concept of God/gods)
- 2) **Animism** (worship of natural objects like the Sun, moon, fire etc.)
- 3) **Totemism** (Worship of Animals like Bull in Greece, Horse in Persia and Cow in Egypt & India)
- 4) **Ancestor worship** (following their traditions and customs blindly)
- 5) **Imaginary gods' Worship** (Like worship of God of fire, goddess of beauty etc. in Greece, Rome, Persia & Iraq)
- 6) **Monotheism** (Belief in One God)

Divine Theory

First man on the earth was aware of God and was His worshipper. Polytheism is a later development.

Emergence of the study of religion emerged as a formal discipline

The study of religion emerged as a formal discipline during the **19th century**, when the methods and approaches of history, philology, literary criticism, psychology, anthropology, sociology, economics, and other fields were brought to bear on the task of determining the history, origins, and functions of religion.